

ingly' 'placed one detachment of his forces where the river first enters the city and another where it leaves it, directing them to go into the channel and attack the town wherever the passage could be effected. After this disposition of his men he withdrew with the less effective of his troops to the marshy ground . . . and pierced the bank, introducing the river into the lake (the lake made by Nitocris some distance from Babylon, see Herodotus, i. 185), by which means the bed of the Euphrates became sufficiently shallow for the object in view. The Persians in their station watched the better opportunity and when the stream had so far retired as not to be higher than their thighs they entered Babylon without difficulty.' The account goes on to say that, as the Babylonians were engaged in a festival, they were completely surprised by the sudden attack and unable to defend the city which thus fell an easy prey to the invaders.

The two cuneiform documents relating to the fall of Babylon which have shed a wonderful light on this period of the world's history are the Cyrus Cylinder and the Annals of Nabonidus, both of which are translated and explained in APPENDIX I. The former was discovered in 1879 by the workmen of Hormuzd Rassam in the ruins of Qaqr at Babylon, a hill which, according to the opinion of Rassam, covers the remains of a great palace, i. e. that of Nebuchadnezzar. The tablet called the 'Annals of Nabonidus' was obtained by the British Museum in 1879 from Spartoli and Co. The place where it was found is unknown, although Mr. Pinches declares decidedly that the document came from Babylon. It seems to belong to a series of annalistic tablets which were collected and preserved by the Achæmenian kings. (See further, APPENDIX I.) The Cyrus Cylinder is a highly laudatory account of Cyrus's

Ἡ Τάξας τὴν στρατιὴν ἅπασαν ἐξ ἐμβολῆς τοῦ ποταμοῦ τῇ ἐς τὴν πόλιν ἐμβάλλει καὶ ὅπισθε αὐτὴς τῆς πόλιος τάξας ἐτέρους τῇ ἐξίει ἐκ τῆς πόλιος ὁ ποταμός, προεῖπε τῷ στρατῷ ὅταν διαβατὸν τὸ ρέεθρον ἴδωνται γενόμενον εἰσεῖναι ταυτὴ ἐς τὴν πόλιν. Οὕτῳ τάξας καὶ κατὰ ταῦτα παραιέσας ἀπῆλανε αὐτὸς σὺν τῷ ἀρχηγῷ τοῦ στρατοῦ. . . . τὸν γὰρ ποταμὸν διώρυχιν ἐσαγαγὼν ἐς τὴν λίμνην εἴσαν ἐλὸς τὸ ἀρχαῖον ρέεθρον διαβατὸν εἶναι ἐποίησε . . . οἱ Πέρσαι οἵπερ ἐτετάχατο 'επ' αὐτῷ τοῦτῳ κατὰ τὸ ρέεθρον τοῦ Εὐφράτῳ ποταμοῦ ὑπονενοσσηκότος ἀνδρὶ ὡς ἐς μέσον μηνὸν μάλιστά κη κατὰ τοῦτο ἐσῆεσαν ἐς τὴν Βαβυλῶνα.

glorious entrance into Babylon, evidently written by some scribe under the Persian rule, while the so-called *Annals* is a concise historical summary of the events of the reign of Nabonidus until the accession of Cyrus, a paragraph being devoted to the events of each year.

Before passing on to the history of the advance of the Persians on Babylonia the following facts should be noticed. After Cyrus, king of the unimportant state of *Anšan*,⁵ according to the record of the *Annals*, had gotten possession of Media, the Persian prince finding himself transformed from the ruler of an insignificant province to the leader of a great kingdom, turned his eyes westward. Here Nabonidus the king of Babylon, who had at first regarded the defeat of his old enemies the Medes⁶ as a direct intervention of the gods, now becoming alarmed at the sudden rise of this new power concluded an offensive and defensive alliance with Lydia and Egypt, a league which should certainly have been sufficient to check the advance of the Persian forces. Lydia was compelled, however, by the swift movements of the enemy to defend herself without waiting for her allies. Cyrus, after totally routing the Lydian army at Pteria,⁷ proceeded directly against Sardis, the capital, which he captured without difficulty and there established his permanent headquarters in the northwest. The Persian king did not hasten at once against Babylonia, his second powerful rival, but, after settling affairs in Lydia and ap-

⁵ For the chronology of Cyrus' reign, his ancestry and kingdom, see Appendix I, note to Cyrus Cyl., l. 21 and to *Annals*, col. 2, l. 15.

⁶ The Medes during the reign of Nabonidus had attacked and destroyed the city of Harran and the temple of Sin. Cf. VR. 64. 12.

⁷ See Herodotus, i. 76. Note that Justin, Hist., i. 7, makes Cyrus begin the war with Babylon before that with Lydia, interrupting his conflict however, in order to conquer Cræsus who had offered aid to Babylon. Sulpicius, Hist., ii. 10, passed directly from the Median conquest to that of Babylonia.—Cræsus, king of Lydia, whom Cyrus captured, was according to Herodotus, i. 75, the brother-in-law of Astyages. Cyrus treated him kindly and gave him the city of Barene near Ecbatana as a residence, according to Ctesias, with five thousand riders and ten thousand bowmen as retinue.

pointing governors* over all the conquered provinces, returned to Ecbatana.

The following historical account of the approach of Cyrus on Babylonia and the fall of that empire may be gathered from the Annals of Nabonidus and the Cyrus Cylinder.

The record of the Annals, which must have been very complete, is unhappily so mutilated that comparatively little can be learned about the early period of the invasion. We may conjecture from a very broken passage (*col. ii. l. 21-22*) that the Persians may have made an invasion from Elam against Erech in the tenth year of Nabonidus (see note to passage, APPENDIX I), but this is by no means certain. Where the text treating of the actual conquest of Babylon is legible, the matter seems practically to be decided. It is stated that Nabonidus entered the Temple of *Eturkalama* (Annals, iii. 6), most probably to seek help from the gods. We may then conjecture,—the translation is very doubtful,—that a rebellion against his authority took place on the lower sea. The god Bel was apparently brought out with a solemn religious festival (*col. iii. 8. 9. 10*), and, as a last resource, numerous deities were brought to Babylon as a protection to that city. This, says the chronicler of the 'Cyrus Cylinder,' so infuriated Marduk, the god of the city of Babylon, that he decided to deliver up Nabonidus to Cyrus (see Cyl. 10^{ff.} and 33, 34). In the month Tammuz (539 B. C.) Cyrus offered battle at Opis and apparently also on a canal (?) Salsallat, which evidently resulted in his favor. (See note to Annals, *col. iii. l. 12*, APPENDIX I.) The Babylonians, defeated on all sides and disgusted with their feeble king, surrendered Sippar to the Persians on the 14th of Tammuz (539-538 B. C.; see Annals iii. 14). As this city was the key to the whole sluice region it was important for Cyrus to get possession of it before he could besiege Babylon successfully. By breaking the dams at Sippar in case of need, the water could be cut off from all the plain. As we have seen, according to the account of Herodotus just

* See Herodotus, i. 153. The post of governor of Sardis was one of the most important positions in the Persian Empire. This official seems to have held the precedence over the neighboring satraps. Compare Nöldeke, *Aufsätze zur altpersischen Geschichte*, p. 21.

given above, Babylon was said to have been captured by the device of drawing off the water of the Euphrates (cf. also Xenophon, *Cyropædia*, vii. 5, 15), but the short space of time intervening between the capture of Sippar and Babylon seems to show that no such device was resorted to. Two days after the capture of Sippar (16th of Tammuz), the gates of the capital itself were opened to Gobryas,⁹ the governor of Gutium and commander of a section of the Persian army, who formally took possession of the city in Cyrus's name. (See *Annals*, iii. 15, and *Cyl.*, l. 17, 'without strife and battle he let him enter into Babylon.')

Nabonidus, who had fled to Babylon after the capture of Sippar, was taken prisoner and held to await the coming of Cyrus. Here again, owing to a doubtful text, we are reduced to conjecture. The Babylonian party seem to have wished to use the temples as storehouses for arms(?), for the troops of Gobryas surrounded them and guarded them carefully. (For other opinions as to the meaning of this passage see note to *col.* iii., l. 17, *Annals*, APPENDIX I.)

Four months later, on the third of Marchešvan, Cyrus himself entered the city of Babylon and decreed peace to all, appointing his general Gobryas governor of the city and sending back to their own shrines the gods which Nabonidus had brought to Babylon. (See *Annals*, iii. 21. and *Cyl.* 33-34.) The Persian monarch was received with great rejoicings by the nobles, priests and people, who hastened to declare their allegiance (*Cyl.* 18). He then assumed formally the title of king of Babylon and of Sumer and Akkad (*Cyl.* 20), receiving

⁹ In the record of the cylinder no mention is made of Gobryas; it is simply stated that Cyrus and his army entered the city without battle. See *Cyl.*, 16, 17. The *Annals*, however, give more details of the conquest and, moreover, are a strictly impartial account. It is much more flattering to Cyrus to attribute to him, as in the Cylinder, all the glory of the capture and not mention any of his generals. It is interesting to notice that Xen., *Cyrop.*, vii. 5, 24 ff., has also preserved the account of the capture of the city by Gobryas, making him, however, a great Assyrian leader, who, desiring vengeance of the king of Babylon for the murder of his only son, allied himself with Cyrus. According to Xenophon, Babylon was taken by the two generals, Gobryas and Gadates.